

Andrew William Doppenberg

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Citizenship: Canadian

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENT

Postdoctoral Fellow 2026–2027
Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto (Toronto, ON)

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Philosophy 2021–2026
University of Toronto (Toronto, ON)
Dissertation: “Flourishing in Diversity: The Promise and Limits of Agent-Based Models”
Committee: Jonathan Weisberg (Supervisor), Franz Huber, David James Barnett, Sara Aronowitz
Examiners: Justin Bruner (External, University at Buffalo), Yonathan Fiat (Internal)
Teaching Mentor: Steven Coyne

B.A., Philosophy (Honours) 2019–2021
University of British Columbia (Vancouver, BC)

B.A.Sc., Engineering Physics 2014–2019
University of British Columbia (Vancouver, BC)

DISSERTATION ABSTRACT

My dissertation asks what philosophers can learn from agent-based models: computer simulations that show how simple interactions can produce surprising group-level outcomes. I argue that these models can clarify mechanisms, test assumptions, and establish philosophical possibilities, but only when their conclusions are matched to what the models actually support. Through case studies on expertise, the social organization of inquiry, and the soul-making response to natural evil, I show both the promise and the limits of using models in philosophical argument.

RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

AOS: Epistemology (Formal and Social), Philosophy of Religion

AOC: Philosophy of Science, Philosophy and Ethics of AI, Logic, Ethics (including Bioethics)

PUBLICATIONS

Doppenberg, A. (2025). Jeffrey conditionalization: Against caution. *Philosophical Studies*, 182, 3135–3148.

Doppenberg, A., Meunier, M., & Boutopoulos, C. (2018). A needle-like optofluidic probe enables targeted intracellular delivery by confining light-nanoparticle interaction on single cell. *Nanoscale*, 10(46), 21871–21878.

Under Review

- “Which Success? The Zollman Effect and Science Policy.”

In Progress (available on request)

- “When Do Track Records Identify Experts? Inertia, Delay, and Public Evidence.”
- “Modelling the Soul-Making Theodicy.”

PRESENTATIONS

- “Should We Use Track Records to Identify Experts?” (refereed) **May 2026**
51st Annual Meeting of the Society for Exact Philosophy, University of British Columbia, Vancouver
- “Gold-nanoparticle-assisted cell perforation by means of an optofluidic probe (needle-like) coupled to a nanosecond laser” (poster) **November 2017**
23rd Annual Meeting of the Vision Health Research Network, Montreal

GRANTS & AWARDS

- SSHRC Doctoral Fellowship (\$80,000) **2024–2026**
Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada
- Schwartz Reisman Institute Embedded Ethics Graduate Teaching Fellowship (\$1,400) **2025–2026**
Schwartz Reisman Institute for Technology and Society
- Ontario Graduate Scholarship (declined in favour of the SSHRC Doctoral Fellowship) **2024–2025**
Government of Ontario
- Ontario Graduate Scholarship (\$15,000) **2022–2023**
Government of Ontario
- Philosophy of Science Award (\$6,000) **2021**
University of Toronto Department of Philosophy
- Graduate Program Award **2021**
University of Toronto Department of Philosophy
- David Bolocan Memorial Prize **2021**
University of British Columbia Department of Philosophy
- James Ruggles Macdonell Memorial Scholarship (\$1,400) **2020**
University of British Columbia Department of Philosophy
- Trek Excellence Scholarship (\$2,250) **2016, 2020**
University of British Columbia

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Course Instructor** **2024–Present**
Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto
- Critical Reasoning
 - Philosophy at the Movies
 - Puzzles and Paradoxes
 - Death and Dying

Embedded Ethics Graduate Teaching Fellow**2025–Present***Department of Computer Science, University of Toronto; Schwartz Reisman Institute for Technology and Society*

- Language Models and Property Rights
- Contact Tracing: Data Collection and Privacy
- Disability and Software Accessibility
- Dataset Ethics
- Data Rights

Teaching Assistant**2021–2026***Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto*

- Philosophy of Artificial Intelligence
- Introduction to Ethics
- Ethics of Artificial Intelligence
- Ethics and Data
- Minds and Machines
- Philosophy of Science
- Probability and Inductive Logic
- Choice and Chance
- Persons, Minds, and Bodies
- Philosophy of Religion
- Early Modern Philosophy

Teaching Assistant**2021***Institute for the History and Philosophy of Science and Technology, University of Toronto*

- Introduction to the Philosophy of Science

GUEST LECTURES**“Normative Ethics”****Winter 2026***Ethical Issues in Software Development, Department of Computer Science, University of Toronto***“Thomas S. Kuhn”****Fall 2021***Introduction to the Philosophy of Science, Institute for the History and Philosophy of Science and Technology, University of Toronto***TEACHING CERTIFICATIONS****Teaching Assistants’ Training Program****2024–2026***Centre for Teaching Support & Innovation, University of Toronto*

Six certificates: Foundations of Teaching in Higher Education; Accessible and Inclusive Teaching; Course Design; Educational Technology; Scholarship of Teaching and Learning; Exploring and Documenting Teaching Experience.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- Canadian Philosophical Association (CPA)
- American Philosophical Association (APA)

2021–Present**2021–Present**

REFERENCES

Jonathan Weisberg, Associate Professor

Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto

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Maanjiwe nendamowinan (room 6152), 3359 Mississauga Rd., Mississauga, ON L5L 1C6

Franz Huber, Associate Professor

Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto

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David James Barnett, Associate Professor

Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto

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Jackman Humanities Building (room 539), 170 St. George Street, Toronto, ON M5R 2M8

Steven Coyne, Assistant Professor (Teaching Stream)

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